PHATSIMO PHEKO

SOC Analyst | Security Operations & SIEM (Wazuh) | Detection Engineering | AWS & OCI Certified
Gaborone, Botswana · +267 7702 8908 · phatsimopheko11@gmail.com
phatsimopheko.com · linkedin.com/in/phatsimo-pheko-728bb6229

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

SOC analyst running day-to-day security operations for an enterprise client environment of 80+ endpoints spanning Windows Server, Red Hat Enterprise Linux, AIX and CentOS, processing 800,000–900,000 security events daily through Wazuh SIEM. Owns L1 triage, incident escalation and the full daily, weekly and monthly SecOps reporting cycle within a small in-house security team, and acts as primary client-facing contact coordinating response across the client and an offshore L2/L3 team. Documented the reporting process inherited from the L2/L3 team and drove its automation in Python, cutting report production time from 1–2 hours to 15–40 minutes and freeing time for deeper alert analysis. Extends this through an ongoing published detection engineering lab series covering Windows telemetry engineering with Sysmon and PowerShell logging, custom correlation rule development mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, detection tuning, and coverage validation. Holds five cloud certifications across Oracle Cloud Infrastructure and AWS, with a software engineering background informing an application-security perspective.

EXPERIENCE

Junior Cybersecurity Consultant — SOC Analyst
October 2024 – Present

TechBulls Botswana | Gaborone, Botswana

- Own L1 security operations for an enterprise client environment of 80+ Wazuh agents across Windows Server, Red Hat Enterprise Linux, AIX and CentOS, processing 800,000–900,000 security events per day.
- Cover the full estate within a small in-house security team, owning the client SecOps reporting function end to end.
- Act as primary client-facing contact for security operations, coordinating incident escalation and remediation between the client and an offshore L2/L3 team across a 3.5-hour time zone gap.
- Produce daily, weekly and monthly SecOps reports covering detection findings, alert severity distribution, endpoint health and remediation recommendations for client stakeholders.
- Drove the automation of daily SecOps reporting using a Python tool, cutting report production from 1–2 hours to 15–40 minutes on a recurring daily task, and validated the automated output against the manual dashboard process.
- Documented the SecOps reporting process inherited from the L2/L3 team to make it repeatable, which became the basis for automating it and freed time for deeper analysis of alert data.
- Triage CVE vulnerability findings across the estate, assessing exposure and coordinating remediation guidance with the client.
- Investigated a web-based attack campaign originating from a single source IP, establishing scope and coordinating response with the client and offshore team.
- Monitor endpoint agent health and connectivity across the fleet, identifying and resolving agent disconnections to maintain continuous visibility.

Cybersecurity Intern
October 2023 – October 2024

TechBulls Botswana | Gaborone, Botswana

- Monitored client endpoint agent health and connectivity across the estate via Wazuh SIEM, verifying continuous coverage and escalating platform issues to the offshore team responsible for L2/L3 support.
- Compiled daily monitoring reports for internal supervisor review, building early security reporting and documentation practice.
- Built working knowledge of the client environment, its telemetry sources and the SIEM platform, later relied on when L1 support transferred in-house.

Tech Support Intern
January 2020 – August 2020

Botswana Accountancy College | Gaborone, Botswana

- Delivered technical support to staff and students, resolving hardware, software and network issues; supported network monitoring, troubleshooting and IT security onboarding for new staff.

PROJECTS

Wazuh Detection Engineering Lab Series
phatsimopheko.com/labs/wazuh-labs

An ongoing, self-directed SIEM lab series published in phases, progressing from SOC deployment through telemetry engineering, custom detection rule development, tuning and detection coverage validation.

- Deployed and maintain a Wazuh SIEM environment (manager, indexer, dashboard) with Linux and Windows agents, including File Integrity Monitoring under a tiered real-time and scheduled monitoring strategy.
- Engineered Windows telemetry coverage across Security, System, PowerShell (Module and Script Block Logging) and Sysmon, using a single controlled trigger to establish what each source captures and where Wazuh's default alerting diverges from the telemetry actually collected.
- Identified that Wazuh's default authentication rules aggregate by source IP and raw failure volume with no account-diversity dimension, leaving low-volume credential stuffing undetected.
- Engineered and deployed custom correlation rules for Linux (sshd) and Windows Security Event Log telemetry mapped to MITRE ATT&CK T1110.004, validated with wazuh-logtest and simulated attacks before deployment.
- Tuned custom rules with ignore windows, reducing alert volume from 16 to 1 on an identically replayed attack while preserving detection.
- Identified a Wazuh frequency-rule suppression defect matching an open upstream issue, where a custom rule firing prevented a built-in rule sharing its base event group from firing.
- Audited declared MITRE ATT&CK coverage against validated detections, classifying each technique by strength of evidence rather than treating rule existence as equivalent to detection capability.

EDUCATION

BSc (Honours) in Computer Systems Engineering August 2017 – August 2021
University of Sunderland

CERTIFICATIONS

- Oracle Cloud Infrastructure 2025 Certified Architect Associate
- Oracle Cloud Infrastructure 2025 Certified Observability Professional
- AWS Certified AI Practitioner
- AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner
- Oracle Cloud Infrastructure 2025 Certified Foundations Associate

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security Operations Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) Deployment & Configuration (Wazuh), Security Operations Centre (SOC) Monitoring, Alert Triage, Threat Detection, Log Analysis & Correlation, Incident Response, Endpoint Security, File Integrity Monitoring (FIM), Vulnerability Management, CVE Triage

Detection Engineering Custom Detection Rule Development, Correlation Rule Design, MITRE ATT&CK Mapping & Coverage Analysis, Detection Tuning, False Positive Reduction, Rule Validation & Testing, Attack Simulation

Telemetry & Logging Windows Security Event Log, Sysmon, PowerShell Module & Script Block Logging, Windows Event Channel Collection, Linux syslog & sshd Authentication Logs

Platforms Windows Server, Red Hat Enterprise Linux, AIX, CentOS, Ubuntu Server

Cloud & Infrastructure Amazon Web Services (AWS), Oracle Cloud Infrastructure (OCI), Identity & Access Management (IAM), Cloud Observability, Cloud Infrastructure Architecture

Reporting & Automation Security Incident Reporting, Process Documentation, Reporting Process Automation, Remediation Documentation

Software Background JavaScript, React, Next.js

Tools Wazuh, wazuh-logtest, Sysmon, Hydra, VirtualBox, Git & GitHub, SQL (MySQL, OracleDB, SQLite)